

# *Araby*

James Joyce · 1914

First published: Dubliners, 1914

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

**Common Core edition** (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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# Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Whole-book test and answer key
6. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

**Edition:** Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Dubliners/Araby (revision 6617246), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

**Grades:** Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). Middle School prompts use the full text when the grade tags include 6–8; otherwise teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

## Essential questions

- What does Araby suggest about romantic idealism and disillusionment?
- What does Araby suggest about coming of age?
- What does Araby suggest about religion and desire?

## Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the story.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

## Standards: Common Core

RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

**Assessments:** Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five

**Differentiation:** Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
**Materials:** Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

## The 90-minute lesson

| # | Segment | Mode | Minutes | Clock |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Bell-ringer | You do | 8 | 0–8 |
| 2 | Vocabulary with etymology notes | I do | 10 | 8–18 |
| 3 | Background and context | I do | 10 | 18–28 |
| 4 | I do: modeled close reading | I do | 12 | 28–40 |
| 5 | We do: guided annotation | We do | 15 | 40–55 |
| 6 | You do: independent annotation | You do | 15 | 55–70 |
| 7 | Discussion | We do | 10 | 70–80 |
| 8 | Exit ticket / chapter quiz | You do | 7 | 80–87 |
| 9 | Closure | I do | 3 | 87–90 |
| | **Total** | | **90** | |

# Syllabus

| Week | Chapters | Lessons | Focus and activities | Assessment |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | *Introduction: author, context and reception*<br>Araby | 2 × 90 min (180 min) | *romantic idealism and disillusionment*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Story quizzes in the app<br>• Introduction: author, context and reception<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |

# Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

# Lesson 1: Introduction to Araby

### *Author biography*

James Joyce was born in Dublin on 2 February 1882 and educated by Jesuits. He left Ireland in 1904 with Nora Barnacle and lived in Trieste, Zurich and Paris, but wrote almost entirely about Dublin. Dubliners (1914), a collection of fifteen stories, was delayed for years by publishers' fears of libel and obscenity; it was followed by A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man (1916), Ulysses (1922) and Finnegans Wake (1939). He died in Zurich on 13 January 1941.

### *Historical and cultural context*

Dublin around 1895 was a city under British rule, shaped by the Catholic Church and economic stagnation. Araby was a real bazaar held in Dublin in May 1894.

### *Publication and reception, then and now*

Published in Dubliners (1914), a collection Joyce completed by 1907 that publishers rejected for years.

**Then:** Dubliners sold poorly.

**Now:** A landmark of modernist short fiction and the "epiphany."

### *Overview (spoiler-free)*

A boy on North Richmond Street is infatuated with his friend's older sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift.

### *Main themes*

- disillusionment.
- romantic idealism.
- paralysis.

### *Why it matters*

Students recognize the experience of a crush and the moment idealism breaks.

Spoilers · teacher only

His uncle comes home late; the boy reaches the bazaar as it closes and finds it shabby; he realizes his romantic dream was vanity.

*Lesson plan (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**

*Before we open Araby: Describe a time something you looked forward to turned out disappointing.*
**Prompt:** Before we open Araby: Describe a time something you looked forward to turned out disappointing.

**8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)**

*epiphany; first-person retrospective narration; imagery; symbolism.*

**18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)**

*About the author. James Joyce was born in Dublin on 2 February 1882 and educated by Jesuits. He left Ireland in 1904 with Nora Barnacle and lived in Trieste, Zurich and Paris, but wrote almost entirely about Dublin. Dubliners (1914), a collection of fifteen stories, was delayed for years by publishers' fears of libel and obscenity; it was followed by A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man (1916), Ulysses (1922) and Finnegans Wake (1939). He died in Zurich on 13 January 1941. The world of the book. Dublin around 1895 was a city under British rule, shaped by the Catholic Church and economic stagnation. Araby was a real bazaar held in Dublin in May 1894. Publication and reception. Published in Dubliners (1914), a collection Joyce completed by 1907 that publishers rejected for years. Then: Dubliners sold poorly. Now: A landmark of modernist short fiction and the "epiphany."*

**28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)**

*"North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street" (Araby, paragraph 1). The opening.*

> *North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street (Araby, paragraph 1)*

**Think-aloud:** "North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street" (Araby, paragraph 1). The opening.

**40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)**

*What the book is about (no spoilers): A boy on North Richmond Street is infatuated with his friend's older sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift. Themes to track: disillusionment.: romantic idealism.: paralysis.:*

**55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)**

*Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question.*
**Task:** Set up a reading journal for Araby: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

*Why does Araby still matter? Students recognize the experience of a crush and the moment idealism breaks.*
**Anchor question:** Why might Araby still be taught today?
**Facilitation:** Students recognize the experience of a crush and the moment idealism breaks.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)**

*What does the boy realize at the end? Answer: That his love was a fantasy driven by vanity.*
**Exit ticket:** What does the boy realize at the end?
**Answer:** That his love was a fantasy driven by vanity.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**

*Tomorrow we begin reading: Araby.*

**Teacher notes · sources:** Britannica, "James Joyce" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/James-Joyce); James Joyce Centre, Dublin (https://jamesjoyce.ie/); James Joyce Centre, Dublin (https://jamesjoyce.ie/)

**Flags (verify before teaching):**

- Araby bazaar date (May 1894) is from Joyce scholarship.

## Lesson 2: Araby

**Focus:** a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion

**Content note ():** No significant sensitive content flagged; preview as usual.
**Student preview:** Nothing in this story needs a special warning.
**Suggested language:** "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A boy on North Richmond Street, Dublin, is infatuated with his friend Mangan's sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift. His uncle comes home late and drunk, and the boy reaches the bazaar as it closes. Seeing a shop girl flirt idly, he feels himself 'a creature driven and derided by vanity.'

**Background:** Collected in Dubliners (1914). The Araby bazaar was a real 1894 Dublin event; Joyce's stories show the 'paralysis' he saw in Irish life.

**Significance:** A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to disillusionment because.... Content note before we start: Nothing in this story needs a special warning.*
**Prompt:** Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to disillusionment because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: his quest collapses.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: impinge — to press against or strike upon; converged — came together from different directions; derided — mocked or ridiculed; garrulous — talking too much, especially about unimportant things; pitilessly — without pity or mercy.*
**Words:** impinge: to press against or strike upon · converged: came together from different directions · derided: mocked or ridiculed · garrulous: talking too much, especially about unimportant things · pitilessly: without pity or mercy

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Collected in Dubliners (1914). The Araby bazaar was a real 1894 Dublin event; Joyce's stories show the 'paralysis' he saw in Irish life. A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1. Epiphany: The final sentence is a sudden self-recognition. Imagery: Light and darkness; religious imagery ("chalice"). Point of view: An older narrator looks back on his younger self. Watch for the bazaar: the exotic dream that turns ordinary.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes" (Araby, paragraph 5). Romantic quest. That is epiphany at work: The final sentence is a sudden self-recognition.*

> *I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes* (Araby, paragraph 5)

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes" (Araby, paragraph 5). Romantic quest. That is epiphany at work: The final sentence is a sudden self-recognition.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The chalice turns errands into a holy quest, showing how he idealizes his love. Ask: How does this line connect to disillusionment? Expected: His quest collapses. (Epiphany.)*

> *Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity* (Araby, paragraph 37)

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The chalice turns errands into a holy quest, showing how he idealizes his love.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to disillusionment?
**Expected answer:** His quest collapses. (Epiphany.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the story for epiphany, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Araby develops the idea of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and point of view shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. When the text says "I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes" (Araby, paragraph 5), it shows this directly. He imagines himself bearing a "chalice safely through a throng of foes," but at the bazaar he sees himself "as a creature driven and derided by vanity."*
**Task:** Annotate the story for epiphany, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Araby develops the idea of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and point of view shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. When the text says "I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes" (Araby, paragraph 5), it shows this directly. He imagines himself bearing a "chalice safely through a throng of foes," but at the bazaar he sees himself "as a creature driven and derided by vanity."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why? Ask: is the ending tragic or a step toward growing up?*
**Anchor question:** Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why?
**Facilitation:** Ask: is the ending tragic or a step toward growing up?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. ("I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes", Araby, paragraph 5). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. ("I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes", Araby, paragraph 5). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how epiphany shapes a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Key takeaway: his quest collapses.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Epiphany:** The final sentence is a sudden self-recognition.
- **Imagery:** Light and darkness; religious imagery ("chalice").
- **Point of view:** An older narrator looks back on his younger self.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **disillusionment:** his quest collapses.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the bazaar:** the exotic dream that turns ordinary.

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes" (Araby, paragraph 5) Romantic quest.
- "Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity" (Araby, paragraph 37) Epiphany.
- "North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street" (Araby, paragraph 1) Paralysis.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion.
**Evidence:** "I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes" (Araby, paragraph 5)
**Reasoning:** He imagines himself bearing a "chalice safely through a throng of foes," but at the bazaar he sees himself "as a creature driven and derided by vanity."

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **impinge** (verb) | to press against or strike upon | *Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **converged** (verb) | came together from different directions | *These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **derided** (verb) | mocked or ridiculed | | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity; and my eyes burned with anguish and anger.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **garrulous** (adjective) | talking too much, especially about unimportant things | *She was an old garrulous woman, a pawnbroker's widow, who collected used stamps for some pious purpose.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **pitilessly** (adverb) | without pity or mercy | *The air was pitilessly raw and already my heart misgave me.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **annihilate** (verb) | to destroy completely | *I wished to annihilate the tedious intervening days.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **liberated** (verb) | set free | *The high cold empty gloomy rooms liberated me and I went from room to room singing.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **parcels** (noun) | packages | *On Saturday evenings when my aunt went marketing I had to go to carry some of the parcels.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **sixpence** (noun) | a small coin of the United Kingdom worth six pennies; not minted since 1970 | *I allowed the two pennies to fall against the sixpence in my pocket.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **weakened** (verb) | lessen the strength of | *Their cries reached me weakened and indistinct and, leaning my forehead against the cool glass, I looked over at the dark house where she lived.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why?
2. Where does imagery appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with romantic idealism and disillusionment?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Where does the boy live? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: North Richmond Street, Dublin

2. Whom does the boy admire? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Mangan's sister
3. Why does he go to Araby? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To buy her a gift
4. Why does he arrive late? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His uncle comes home late
5. What does the boy feel at the end? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Anguish and anger at his own vanity
6. Retell the three most important events of "Araby" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A boy on North Richmond Street, Dublin, is infatuated with his friend Mangan's sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift. His uncle comes home late and drunk, and the boy reaches the bazaar as it closes. Seeing a shop girl flirt idly, he feels himself 'a creature driven and derided by vanity.'
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Araby"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Araby" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: "Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds." What does "impinge" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: impinge: to press against or strike upon.
10. Reread: "These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes." What does "converged" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: converged: came together from different directions.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. What does "Araby" suggest about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.
2. Find one example of imagery in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
3. How does the point of view in this story shape what we understand about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: "I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes" (Araby, paragraph 5): Romantic quest. On point of view: An older narrator looks back on his younger self. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "One evening I went into the back drawing-room in which the priest had died.", why might Joyce have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

5. What causes the main turn in “Araby”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A boy on North Richmond Street, Dublin, is infatuated with his friend Mangan's sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift. His uncle comes home late and drunk, and the boy reaches the bazaar as it closes. Seeing a shop girl flirt idly, he feels himself 'a creature…
6. As the opening story, what does “Araby” set up that the rest of Araby will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37): Epiphany. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1): Paralysis. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with romantic idealism and disillusionment? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5): Romantic quest. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Collected in Dubliners (1914). The Araby bazaar was a real 1894 Dublin event; Joyce's stories show the 'paralysis' he saw in Irish life. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37): Epiphany. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. A critic might argue: “A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1):

Paralysis. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5): Romantic quest. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Araby” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37): Epiphany. On point of view: An older narrator looks back on his younger self. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Araby”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1): Paralysis. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to coming of age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Joyce need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5): Romantic quest. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the imagery in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37): Epiphany. On imagery: Light and darkness; religious imagery ("chalice"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Araby” treats a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Araby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1):

Paralysis. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve romantic idealism and disillusionment? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes” (Araby, paragraph 5): Romantic quest. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity” (Araby, paragraph 37): Epiphany. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask James Joyce about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The boy's quest ends in a painful realization of his own illusion. Useful evidence: “North Richmond Street, being blind, was a quiet street” (Araby, paragraph 1): Paralysis. Theme link: his quest collapses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Point of view**: who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Where does the boy live?
   A. London
   B. Belfast
   C. Cork
   D. North Richmond Street, Dublin
2. Whom does the boy admire?
   A. Mangan's sister
   B. His aunt
   C. A nun
   D. A shop girl

3. Why does he go to Araby?
   A. To buy her a gift
   B. To work
   C. To meet friends
   D. To see his uncle
4. Why does he arrive late?
   A. The train breaks
   B. His uncle comes home late
   C. He gets lost
   D. He oversleeps
5. What does the boy feel at the end?
   A. Anguish and anger at his own vanity
   B. Relief
   C. Joy
   D. Love
6. In the line “Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds.”, what does “impinge” most nearly mean?
   A. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
   B. mocked or ridiculed
   C. came together from different directions
   D. to press against or strike upon
7. In the line “These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes.”, what does “converged” most nearly mean?
   A. to press against or strike upon
   B. came together from different directions
   C. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
   D. mocked or ridiculed

**Answer key:** 1. D (North Richmond Street, Dublin); 2. A (Mangan's sister); 3. A (To buy her a gift); 4. B (His uncle comes home late); 5. A (Anguish and anger at his own vanity); 6. D (to press against or strike upon); 7. B (came together from different directions)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this story is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Araby,” how does Joyce show a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Araby, how does Joyce develop the idea of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the story helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Araby develops the idea of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and point of view shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Araby (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Araby suggests about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's imagery and point of view), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how James Joyce uses imagery in Araby to complicate the reader's understanding of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Araby within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Araby alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Araby and its treatment of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's imagery and point of view, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Araby as evidence for a larger claim about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion in Araby. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Araby as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion.

Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Araby.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity; and my eyes burned with anguish and anger.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "derided" most nearly mean?

   A. a small coin of the United Kingdom worth six pennies; not minted since 1970

   B. packages

   C. mocked or ridiculed

   D. lessen the strength of

2. *One evening I went into the back drawing-room in which the priest had died. It was a dark rainy evening and there was no sound in the house. Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds. Some distant lamp or lighted window gleamed below me. I was thankful that I could see so little. All my senses seemed to desire to veil themselves and, feeling that I was about to slip from them, I pressed the palms of my hands together until they trembled, murmuring: "O love! O love!" many times.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Araby"?

   A. The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are

   B. Courage in defense of home

   C. A boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion

   D. The futile attempt to shut out death

**SAT key:** 1. C (mocked or ridiculed); 2. C (A boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion)

# Whole-book test

**Araby: whole-book test** · 90 minutes

## Part I: Multiple choice

1. Where does the boy live?
   A. London
   B. Belfast
   C. Cork
   D. North Richmond Street, Dublin
2. Whom does the boy admire?
   A. Mangan's sister
   B. His aunt
   C. A nun
   D. A shop girl
3. Why does he go to Araby?
   A. To buy her a gift
   B. To work
   C. To meet friends
   D. To see his uncle
4. Why does he arrive late?
   A. The train breaks
   B. His uncle comes home late
   C. He gets lost
   D. He oversleeps
5. What does the boy feel at the end?
   A. Anguish and anger at his own vanity
   B. Relief
   C. Joy
   D. Love
6. In the line “Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds.”, what does “impinge” most nearly mean?
   A. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
   B. mocked or ridiculed
   C. came together from different directions
   D. to press against or strike upon

7. In the line “These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes.”, what does “converged” most nearly mean?
   A. to press against or strike upon
   B. came together from different directions
   C. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
   D. mocked or ridiculed
8. As used in the story (“Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds.”), what does “impinge” mean?
   A. to press against or strike upon
   B. without pity or mercy
   C. packages
   D. came together from different directions
9. As used in the story (“These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes.”), what does “converged” mean?
   A. to destroy completely
   B. came together from different directions
   C. a small coin of the United Kingdom worth six pennies; not minted since 1970
   D. mocked or ridiculed
10. As used in the story (“Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity; and my eyes burned with anguish and anger.”), what does “derided” mean?
    A. set free
    B. lessen the strength of
    C. mocked or ridiculed
    D. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
11. As used in the story (“She was an old garrulous woman, a pawnbroker's widow, who collected used stamps for some pious purpose.”), what does “garrulous” mean?
    A. packages
    B. to press against or strike upon
    C. without pity or mercy
    D. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
12. As used in the story (“The air was pitilessly raw and already my heart misgave me.”), what does “pitilessly” mean?
    A. without pity or mercy
    B. a small coin of the United Kingdom worth six pennies; not minted since 1970
    C. came together from different directions
    D. to destroy completely

## Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how romantic idealism and disillusionment develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
2. Explain how coming of age develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
3. Explain how religion and desire develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.

## Part III: Essay

Choose one of the story's central concerns (romantic idealism and disillusionment, coming of age, religion and desire) and argue how the ending reframes it.

## Answer key

**Answer key:** 1. D (North Richmond Street, Dublin); 2. A (Mangan's sister); 3. A (To buy her a gift); 4. B (His uncle comes home late); 5. A (Anguish and anger at his own vanity); 6. D (to press against or strike upon); 7. B (came together from different directions); 8. A (to press against or strike upon); 9. B (came together from different directions); 10. C (mocked or ridiculed); 11. D (talking too much, especially about unimportant things); 12. A (without pity or mercy)

# Essay assignments

## Essay: Romantic idealism and disillusionment

**Middle School** (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Araby teaches about romantic idealism and disillusionment. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how James Joyce develops romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how James Joyce develops romantic idealism and disillusionment across Araby. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Araby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of romantic idealism and disillusionment. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how James Joyce's choices in Araby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of romantic idealism and disillusionment, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Araby's treatment of romantic idealism and disillusionment in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby, engaging at least four

scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Coming of age

**Middle School** (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Araby teaches about coming of age. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how James Joyce develops coming of age in Araby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how James Joyce develops coming of age across Araby. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Araby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of coming of age. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of coming of age in Araby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how James Joyce's choices in Araby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of coming of age, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Araby's treatment of coming of age in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on coming of age in Araby that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on coming of age in Araby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about coming of age in Araby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on coming of age in Araby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Religion and desire

**Middle School** (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Araby teaches about religion and desire. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how James Joyce develops religion and desire in Araby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how James Joyce develops religion and desire across Araby. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Araby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of religion and desire. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of religion and desire in Araby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how James Joyce's choices in Araby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of religion and desire, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Araby's treatment of religion and desire in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on religion and desire in Araby that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on religion and desire in Araby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about religion and desire in Araby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on religion and desire in Araby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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